

Document 22: International Semester Exchange & Credit Transfer Guidelines

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1. Global Mobility and Semester Exchange Eligibility

The Hyderabad Institute of Technology operates a robust Global Mobility Program, allowing high-performing undergraduate students to complete exactly one academic semester at a partnered foreign university. This international exposure is designed to foster cross-cultural technical collaboration and prepare students for global corporate environments.

The Semester Exchange program is strictly restricted to a student's fifth or sixth semester (the third year of the B.Tech program). Freshmen and sophomores lack the core engineering foundation required by foreign partners, while final-year students must remain on campus to complete their Major Final Year Project and participate in the Training and Placement drives.

To apply for the Semester Exchange Program, a student must meet uncompromising academic criteria by the end of their fourth semester. The student must maintain a minimum Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of 8.0, possess absolutely zero active or cleared backlogs in their academic history, and hold a valid Indian passport with a minimum of eighteen months of remaining validity. Furthermore, the student must pass the internal Global Mobility Interview, which evaluates their English communication skills and cultural adaptability.

2. Partner Universities and The Pre-Departure Learning Agreement

HIT maintains active Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) with twenty-four foreign universities across the United States, the United Kingdom, Germany, and Singapore. Students cannot independently choose a random foreign university; they must select an institution exclusively from the approved MoU Partner List provided by the Office of International Affairs (OIA).

Before a student is permitted to board a flight, they must digitally sign a "Pre-Departure Learning Agreement." This is the most critical document in the exchange process. The student, their HIT Faculty Advisor, and the Head of the Department must sit together and map the subjects offered at the foreign university to the exact subjects the student was supposed to study at HIT during that semester.

A minimum of 75% of the foreign syllabus must directly match the HIT syllabus for a subject to be approved for credit transfer. If a student chooses to study a foreign subject that has no equivalent in the HIT curriculum (for example, a mechanical student taking a course in European Renaissance Art), that subject will be classified as an "Audit Course." The student will not receive any HIT academic credits for audit courses, meaning they may fall short of their semester credit requirements and face a Year-Back penalty upon their return.

3. Financial Mechanics: Tuition Fee Waivers and Living Expenses

The financial structure of the Semester Exchange Program operates on a "Home Tuition" model to make studying abroad affordable for Indian students.

Under this model, the exchange student is completely exempted from paying the massive international tuition fees charged by the foreign partner university. Instead, the student simply pays their standard HIT Annual Institutional Fee (e.g., ₹1,45,000 for Category-A students) to the HIT accounts department in July, exactly as if they were studying in Hyderabad.

However, all other financial burdens are the sole responsibility of the student and their family. The university does not sponsor flight tickets, international student visas, mandatory foreign health insurance, or daily living expenses. Students must prove they have the financial capacity to support themselves abroad. During the application phase, the student must submit a verified bank statement showing a minimum liquid balance of ₹8,00,000 (Eight Lakh Rupees) to guarantee they will not become destitute in a foreign country.

4. Visa Compliance and The Deportation Clause

Students traveling abroad operate as official ambassadors of the Hyderabad Institute of Technology. Consequently, strict adherence to the host country's immigration laws is heavily monitored by the OIA.

Students must secure a J-1 (USA), Tier 4 (UK), or equivalent temporary student visa. It is strictly illegal for an exchange student to work off-campus in the host country (such as driving an Uber or working in a local restaurant) unless explicit, written authorization is granted by both the host country's immigration department and the HIT OIA.

If a student is caught violating their visa conditions, or if they are arrested for a criminal offense in the foreign country (including severe traffic violations or public intoxication), they will trigger the "Deportation Clause." The foreign university will instantly terminate their exchange semester, and the host country will deport the student back to India. Upon arrival, HIT will permanently rusticate the student, completely canceling their engineering degree, and blocking their access to all future academic transcripts.

5. The Grade Conversion Algorithm

Because foreign universities utilize entirely different grading scales, HIT employs a strict mathematical conversion algorithm to map the credits earned abroad back to the standard HIT 10-point CGPA scale.

The United States Conversion (4.0 Scale to 10.0 Scale): If a student studies at a US partner university, their grades are awarded on a 4.0 GPA scale. To convert this to the HIT system, the OIA utilizes a multiplier formula. The American GPA is multiplied by 2.5 to generate the equivalent HIT SGPA.

- *Example:* If a student earns a 3.6 GPA in the United States, it is calculated as (3.6×2.5) , resulting in a 9.0 SGPA on the HIT transcript.
- If the converted score results in a fraction, standard mathematical rounding is applied. A 3.3 US GPA converts to 8.25, which rounds up to an 8.3 HIT SGPA.

The European Credit Transfer System (ECTS): European partner universities award ECTS credits, which operate on a different volume scale than Indian credits. At HIT, one standard Indian academic credit equals exactly two ECTS credits. Therefore, if a student completes a massive 6-ECTS project in Germany, it will only be recorded as a 3-credit course on their final HIT transcript. Students must carefully calculate their ECTS load to ensure they do not return to India with a credit deficit.

6. Post-Exchange Transcript Integration and Deadlines

The academic credits earned abroad are not automatically synchronized with the HIT examination portal. The returning student is responsible for initiating the integration process.

Within fourteen calendar days of returning to India, the student must submit the original, sealed physical transcript provided by the foreign university to the HIT Controller of Examinations. Digital PDFs or unsealed envelopes brought in a backpack are instantly rejected due to the risk of forgery. The foreign university must either mail the sealed transcript directly to the HIT campus or provide it to the student in a tamper-proof, stamped envelope.

If the foreign university operates on a delayed academic calendar (for example, releasing transcripts in late February for a Fall semester), the student is temporarily awarded an "I-Grade" (Incomplete) on their HIT portal. This I-Grade protects the student from being flagged as a failure. However, if the official foreign transcript is not submitted to HIT by March 31st, the I-Grade automatically converts to an F-Grade (Fail), and the student must sit for supplementary examinations in Hyderabad to recover the lost credits.